Nalanda's population to be 3000, resident in just seven monasteries.[6] This muddies the water a great deal. Historians have tended to pick and choose between these two very different numbers based largely on their subjective analyses and purposes. Going by the archaeological evidence, historian A.L. Basham, in *The Wonder That Was India*, favoured an estimate even smaller than Yijing's. Nalanda Mahavihara, Basham wrote, 'consisted of a very large complex of buildings but it could hardly have accommodated a thousand monks in anything like the comfort described by the Chinese traveler [Xuanzang]'. Meanwhile, archaeologist H.D. Sankalia favoured an estimate of 4000.[7] In short, there is no consensus on how many monks and teachers were at Nalanda even in the century when it may have been at its prime and for which we have the maximum historical records.



Figure 3. The Great Monument

Each monastery was led by a learned master, with additional teachers aiding him. Students were taught by multiple teachers and were likely split in groups based on their knowledge and interests. The teachers held their